Personal Reading List and Notes

Carlos Moore | 2023 to 2025 reads | Updated February 2026

FICTION - John Grisham

Title	Year Read	Rating	Notes
The Firm	2023	5/5	Re-read. Still the best legal thriller I have read. The pacing holds up.
The Pelican Brief	2023	4/5	Fast. Good courtroom tension. Darby Shaw is an excellent lead.
The Rainmaker	2024	4.5/5	Underrated. The David versus Goliath angle with the insurer lands.
A Time for Mercy	2024	4/5	Slower start but the Jake Brigance arc has earned its weight.
The Exchange	2025	4/5	Good follow-up to The Firm, though lighter than the original.

FICTION - Michael Connelly

Title	Year Read	Rating	Notes
The Lincoln Lawyer	2023	5/5	Mickey Haller works the gray area in a way that feels real.
The Brass Verdict	2023	4.5/5	The Bosch crossover was well earned. Pace is tight.
The Reversal	2024	4.5/5	Haller and Bosch together again. The courtroom drama is sharp.
The Gods of Guilt	2024	4/5	Good but slightly long. The social media storyline drags a little.
The Night Fire	2025	5/5	Bosch aging out but not down. This is what good crime writing looks like.

NON-FICTION - Leadership and Self-Improvement

Title	Author	Year	Rating	Notes
Leaders Eat Last	Simon Sinek	2024	4.5/5	The circle of safety concept changed how I lead.
The 21 Irrefutable Laws of Leadership	John Maxwell	2024	4/5	Some laws feel circular but 14 of 21 are genuinely useful.
The Obesity Code	Dr. Jason Fung	2025	4/5	Not leadership but changed my eating habits.
The Culture Code	Daniel Coyle	2025	4.5/5	Best book on building team culture I have read.
Extreme Ownership	Jocko Willink and Leif Babin	2023	3.5/5	Valuable core idea but overly military in framing.

CURRENTLY READING

- The Midnight Library by Matt Haig. Imani recommended it. About 40 pages in.
- SHRM-SCP Exam Prep Guide, 4th Edition. Chapter 6, Talent Acquisition.

ON DECK

- The Covenant of Water by Abraham Verghese. Tanya recommended.
- Dare to Lead by Brene Brown. On the committee recommended reading list.
- The Motive by Patrick Lencioni.